MERIDIAN GLOBAL LOGISTICS

Employee Handbook

Version 2.1 | Effective 1 January 2026 | People & Culture Department

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This handbook is a synthetic/sample document created for testing an internal employee assistant chatbot. Meridian Global Logistics is a fictional company; all figures and policies are for demonstration purposes only.

Table of Contents

1. About Meridian Global Logistics
2. Company Structure & Departments
3. Working Hours & Attendance
4. Leave Policy
5. How to Apply for Leave
6. Compensation & Benefits
7. Travel & Expense Policy
8. Code of Conduct
9. IT & Data Security Policy
10. Employee Support & Contacts

1. About Meridian Global Logistics

Meridian Global Logistics (MGL) is an international logistics and freight-forwarding company operating across 15 hub locations worldwide, including Mumbai, Singapore, Dubai, Rotterdam, New York, Shanghai, Nairobi, and Hamburg. Founded to simplify cross-border trade, MGL provides ocean freight, air freight, customs brokerage, warehousing, and supply chain planning services to over 3,000 corporate clients globally.

MGL currently employs approximately 2,000 people across 10 departments: Freight Forwarding, Warehousing, Customs Brokerage, Fleet Management, Customer Service, Sales & Business Development, Finance, Human Resources, IT & Systems, and Supply Chain Planning.

2. Company Structure & Departments

- **Freight Forwarding** — manages ocean and air cargo bookings, documentation, and carrier relationships.
- **Warehousing** — operates fulfillment and storage facilities across all hub locations.
- **Customs Brokerage** — handles import/export compliance, tariff classification, and customs filings.
- **Fleet Management** — manages the company's owned and leased transport fleet.
- **Customer Service** — first point of contact for client shipment tracking and issue resolution.
- **Sales & Business Development** — manages client accounts and new business acquisition.
- **Supply Chain Planning** — forecasts demand and optimizes shipping routes and inventory.

3. Working Hours & Attendance

Standard working hours are 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM local time, Monday through Friday, with a one-hour lunch break. Warehouse and Fleet Management staff may be assigned to shift schedules depending on operational needs at their location.

3.1 Attendance Tracking

- All employees must clock in/out via the MGL Connect HR portal or the mobile app.
- Field and warehouse staff mark attendance via the mobile app with geolocation enabled.
- Persistent late arrivals (3+ times per month) result in an attendance advisory from HR.

4. Leave Policy

MGL provides the following leave entitlements per calendar year to all confirmed full-time employees, prorated for employees joining mid-year. Leave balances are visible to each employee via the MGL Connect portal or the employee assistant chatbot.

4.1 Leave Entitlements

- **Casual Leave (CL):** 12 days per year, credited monthly.
- **Sick Leave (SL):** 10 days per year; a medical certificate is required beyond 2 consecutive days.
- **Earned Leave (EL):** 15 days per year, accrued quarterly, carried forward up to a maximum of 45 days.
- **Maternity Leave:** 26 weeks paid, extendable by 8 weeks unpaid on request.
- **Paternity Leave:** 15 days paid, to be availed within 3 months of the child's birth.
- **Bereavement Leave:** 5 days paid for the death of an immediate family member.

4.2 Leave Carry-Forward & Encashment

Unused Casual and Sick Leave lapse at the end of the calendar year and cannot be carried forward or encashed. Earned Leave carries forward up to a cap of 45 days; any balance beyond the cap is automatically encashed at the December payroll cycle.

5. How to Apply for Leave

Employees can apply for leave in two ways:

- Through the MGL Connect HR portal, under “Leave & Attendance → Apply Leave.”
- Through the MGL employee assistant chatbot, by providing your Employee ID, the leave type, and the number of days — the assistant will check your balance and confirm the application instantly for Casual and Sick Leave. Earned Leave, Maternity, Paternity, and Bereavement Leave require manager approval and should be routed through the HR portal.

All leave (except sudden sick leave) must be applied for at least 3 working days in advance. Sick leave taken without prior notice must be regularized within 2 working days of returning to work.

6. Compensation & Benefits

- Group health insurance covering the employee, spouse, and up to 2 dependent children.
- Provident Fund / retirement contribution as per local statutory requirements at each hub location.
- Annual wellness allowance for gym membership, mental health support, or preventive health checkups.
- Relocation and international assignment allowances for staff transferring between hub locations.

7. Travel & Expense Policy

Employees traveling for client visits, port inspections, or inter-hub coordination may claim reimbursement through MGL Connect within 30 days of the expense being incurred. Economy-class airfare is standard; business class requires VP-level approval for flights over 6 hours.

8. Code of Conduct

All MGL employees are expected to act with integrity in dealings with clients, customs authorities, carriers, and colleagues. Given the regulated nature of international freight and customs brokerage, employees in Customs Brokerage and Freight Forwarding are held to additional compliance training requirements, renewed annually.

9. IT & Data Security Policy

- Multi-factor authentication (MFA) is mandatory for MGL Connect and all shipment tracking systems.
- Client shipment and customs data must never be stored on personal devices or personal cloud accounts.
- Suspected data breaches or phishing attempts must be reported to IT Security within 2 hours.

10. Employee Support & Contacts

For questions not covered here, or for leave types requiring manager approval, contact your local HR Business Partner or email people@meridianlogistics.com. The employee assistant chatbot can answer general policy questions and Casual/Sick Leave balance or application queries directly, using your Employee ID.